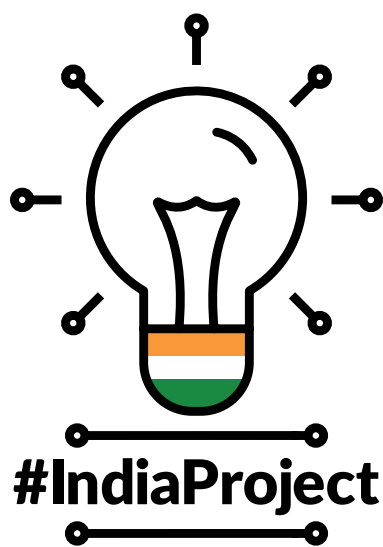


isn't going to cut it. Advertising is something that companies pay us (and all other media companies) for, because it works – it's how information of new products reaches most of you. Thus, in true Digit fashion, we decided to find a way to make *less money*, in order to help deserving entrepreneurs make more.

Starting September 2020, we invite small technology businesses in India who have an innovative idea, and are just getting started (under 5 Cr in turnover), to get in touch with us (india@digit.in) to avail of up to ₹1.5 million worth of advertising



and promotions across all of Digit's platforms... for absolutely free!

There are no catches here, if the company is selected by our panel, we will help promote them to you, our readers, for completely free.

THE NEXUS CONNECTION

While we were discussing this idea, we found out about Nexus (you will read more about that in the pages that follow). The Nexus Startup Hub is an innovation hub and business incubator that is a collaboration between the US Embassy (New Delhi) and ACIR (The Alliance for Commercialisation and Innovation Research). Nexus basically identifies promising Indian startups and entrepreneurs and mentors them, for totally free, thanks to sponsorship by the US Government, in order to promote

innovation in India, and help prepare and train entrepreneurs using learnings from the world's biggest market and companies in the US.

As soon as we heard that there was someone else also trying to help Indian companies, for free, we had to get in touch with them and join forces. We're happy to announce that we will start off #IndiaProject with all of the startups who have been and are being incubated by Nexus. All of those startups automatically qualify for the 1.5 million in advertising from Digit, across all of our platforms.

We also want to make sure that all of you budding entrepreneurs out there know of Nexus now, and can apply to them for mentorship. You will have to go through their selection process, of course, but it's worth it if you get through.

HOW CAN YOU HELP?

Not all of us are cut out for business or entrepreneurship, and in fact, most of us are consumers who just love buying technology and products. So how can we, the majority of India, help an initiative like #IndiaProject?

Honestly, this whole thing falls flat on its face without you. You are the most important cog or part in the machinery!

For months now readers have been looking for Indian companies to support, or Made in India products to buy, and we've all complained about the lack of proper Indian options in almost every product segment. Well, this is your chance to change that.

While nothing happens overnight, what India will look like a decade from now depends totally on what you do when you read this article, and what you do from now on.

If you share this article with your friends, or if you inform them of #IndiaProject, we can help spread the word. Very soon you will see #IndiaProject ads start to show up in this magazine, on our site, inside our videos, social media posts and everything we do. These ads, posts and articles will be promoting Indian companies, Indian ideas and fellow Indians, and you can help by clicking

on those ads or posts, reading about them, and sharing them with your friends on whatever communication channel you like and already use.

Every advertisement or social post or article that we write for #IndiaProject will carry the hashtag and the icon/logo we have displayed on all the pages of this cover story. In this way you can easily know when we are promoting this initiative, and easily identify #IndiaProject content, in order to share it far and wide with friends.

The success or failure of this initiative lies solely with you. What will you do with this power?

COPYLEFT

This is not some gimmick we wanted to create in order to try and benefit our brand. To prove that, we want to release this idea as copyleft (public domain) instead. We actively encourage all other media houses to do this themselves. We encourage influencers in every vertical and on every platform (Instagram, YouTube, Twitch, TikTok, etc), to do the same thing. We encourage popular actors to support small Indie film producers, sports persons can adopt and promote a local sports team. All across India, we're hoping fellow Indians will support one another, and promote businesses or proucts they like, instead of being jaded and only speaking up to complain when things go wrong.

If anyone wants to use the same hashtag as us – #IndiaProject – we welcome them to do so, because we do not want this to “belong” to Digit. If someone wants to come up with their own initiative and own hash tag or title, we welcome that as well. Let us know if you do, we'll help promote your initiative, with your own catchphrase or hash tag as well! As long as we're all building Indian success stories, we support you 100 percent and we love you for it.

Now, please make sure to share this article, and if you don't want to do that for any reason, please at least pass on the general idea to your friends and family.

Jai Hind!